



GDD 19 Speak Up

From bystander to upstander

The speak-up game for ages 9-12, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard. Children learn to name the forms of gender-based harm, choose from five safe upstander moves, find the words, and know where to get help, including India's Childline. Seven mechanics, 39 upstander-action moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

From bystander to upstander.

Speak Up is the bystander-to-upstander game. Children learn to name the forms of gender-based harm (gendered name-calling, exclusion, unwanted touch, body-mocking, online hate), to pick from five safe ways to help, to find the actual words, and to know exactly where to turn for help. It takes Not Fair, Not Funny's "harm isn't a joke" foundation (g11) and adds the upstander toolkit and a real route to support. New v2 build to the standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g19 · speak-up (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 3 · ages 9-12 · light canvas · solo or peer
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.3, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g18 (Norm Storm) · builds on g11 (Not Fair, Not Funny)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the bystander-to-upstander game.

85

scenarios

7

mechanics

39

upstander moves

5

safe helping moves

0%

binary taps

The age harm gets a witness.

From the Chapter 3 personas. By 9-12, children witness real gender-based harm at school, on the bus, online, this game turns the helpless "I didn't know what to do" into a toolkit they can actually use.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Diya, 11 (excluded, body-teased)	To know others can and will step in for her.	branch + role-play: include & defend.
Aarav, 12 (mocked for being gentle; froze once)	Safe ways to act, and a second chance after freezing.	branch: pick a safe move; try again.
Asha, 24 (peer educator)	To model help-seeking and that telling isn't tattling.	strike-rewrite + match: where to get help.
Every child	The words and the helplines, ready in the moment.	role-play + match: lines & 1098.

Why this works (the evidence). Bystanders can act safely using the five Ds (Distract, Delegate, Document, Delay, Direct), strategies designed to reduce harm without escalating danger. Gender-based harm at this age includes gendered name-calling, exclusion, unwanted touching, body-mocking and online harassment, and the target is never to blame. Telling a trusted adult is help-seeking, not tattling, and India's Childline 1098 (now linked with the 112 emergency number) is a 24-hour helpline for children.

Five safe ways to help.

The spine of the game, the five Ds, translated for ages 9-12. Every move is designed to help without escalating danger, the child always has at least one safe option.

MOVE	THE CHILD DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
Say something Direct	Calmly names it: "that's not okay, stop".	When it feels safe and clear.
Distract	Breaks the moment, a question, dropped books.	When direct feels unsafe.
Get help Delegate	Fetches a teacher or trusted adult.	For anything serious or scary.
Check in Delay	Afterwards: "are you okay? that wasn't fair".	Once the moment has passed.
Report Document	Doesn't forward; saves proof, reports, tells an adult.	For online harm.

Safety first. The game never asks a child to fight or to confront danger alone. For anything physical or scary, the right move is always **Get help**, an adult, or Childline **1098 / 112**.

Seven moves, led by the choice.

The rework's heart: upstanding arrives through seven actions, and this is the game where **branch** rightly leads, every dilemma is a real "what would you do?" with a safe outcome and a debrief. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (bystander dilemma) signature	Chooses an upstander move and sees it play out safely.	Acting in the moment.	25
role-play (voice)	Says the actual upstander line out loud.	Finding the words.	14
sort	Sorts harm vs okay; safe move vs risky; upstander vs bystander.	Judgement.	12
spot	Recognises the harm (and the upstander) in a scene.	Naming harm.	10
strike-rewrite	Flips a silencing myth ("telling is tattling").	Conceptual change.	10
reflect	Considers what kind of bystander they want to be.	Identity; empathy.	10
match	Pairs a situation to the right helper or helpline.	Help-seeking routes.	4

39 of 85 moments are branch or role-play, the child actually decides and speaks. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

Built, not bolted on.

85 researched scenarios across the name → why → moves → words → help → act arc, grounded in real situations and safe practice. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Name the harm	14	spot, sort, strike-rewrite	Slurs, exclusion, body-mocking, touch, online; "joke" cover.
Why speaking up matters	12	strike-rewrite, reflect, sort	Silence isn't neutral; the bystander trap; no victim-blaming.
The five upstander moves	17	branch, sort, role-play	Say something, distract, get help, check in, report.
Find the words	12	role-play, branch	The actual upstander lines; trying again after freezing.
Where to get help	14	match, branch, strike-rewrite	Trusted adults, Childline 1098/112; telling isn't tattling.
Be the upstander	16	branch, spot, reflect	Real dilemmas; combining moves; being first; staying safe.

A branch scenario (the five moves, Get help), verbatim.

hook: "Move 3, GET HELP. The harm is serious or scary."

option A "Find a teacher or trusted adult fast" -> an adult can step in with authority [best]

option B "Try to handle a scary situation alone" -> for serious harm, getting an adult is the right move

debrief: "The Delegate move: bring in an adult for anything serious or scary."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 19 Speak Up — Scenario Library.json](#) (85 records, v2 schema).

What this game erases.

SILENCING MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
If it's not happening to me, it's none of my business.	When you see harm, speaking up is everyone's business.	Allyship.
Telling an adult is just tattling.	Tattling gets someone in trouble; telling keeps someone safe.	Help-seeking.
Staying silent is the safe, neutral choice.	Silence can leave the person being harmed feeling alone.	Bystander effect.
Someone else will surely step in.	When everyone thinks that, no one acts; you can be the one.	Bystander trap.
They must have done something to deserve it.	Harm is never the fault of the person being hurt.	No victim-blaming.
If it's a joke, it can't be harmful.	A "joke" that hurts or humiliates is still harm.	Naming harm.
Asking for help means I'm weak.	Asking for help is a smart, strong thing to do.	Help-seeking.
I'm just a kid; I can't make a difference.	Kids are upstanders every day; your action counts.	Agency.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "something's not okay here, what do you do?".
2. **Play.** Name the harm (spot), pick a safe move (branch), or say the line (role-play), rotated.
3. **Safe outcome.** The chosen move plays out, helping without escalating; weaker choices get a gentle "here's a safer way".
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a silencing myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("telling" not "tattling").
5. **Route to help.** Serious scenarios always surface a trusted adult and Childline 1098 / 112.
6. **Sticker.** The Upstander badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **five-moves chooser**, witness the harm, pick a safe move, watch it help. This becomes the reference implementation for Stand Up (g27) and the wider safety and respect nodes.

Help safely, never alone.

- **Register.** Ages 9-12, caring and matter-of-fact; harm is named plainly but never shown graphically.
- **Safety over heroics.** No scenario rewards fighting or confronting danger alone; the safe move (get help) is always honoured.
- **Never blame the target.** The game is explicit that harm is never the fault of the person being hurt.
- **Telling is not tattling.** Help-seeking is reframed as brave and right, with a clear tattle-vs-tell distinction.
- **Real routes to help.** Trusted adults, school counsellors, and Childline 1098 / 112 appear as concrete, reachable options (UNESCO 5.5).
- **Freezing is okay.** Children who froze get a second chance; courage is framed as acting through fear.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded; pairs with Not Fair, Not Funny (g11) and Safety Squad (g08).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. speak-up** — `node.game === GameDone key === registry id` (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. Each scenario carries type + typed payload; the **branch** renderer (options + consequence + outcome + debrief) drives the five-moves chooser, with **role-play** for the lines and **match** for help routes.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, branch at 29%, 0% binary, 39 autonomy, 10 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Childline 1098 / 112 surfaced via a shared "get help" component, single source of truth so the number updates app-wide.
- **Reuse**. The five-moves chooser is the reference for Stand Up (g27) and Defenders of the Body (g20); build once, reuse.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the `xlsx` + `gen-path`, never hand-edited `path.ts`.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): safety over heroics; never blame the target; telling is not tattling; always offer a real route to help; freezing is okay; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **The five Ds are evidence-based and safe.** Distract, Delegate, Document, Delay and Direct were developed precisely so bystanders can intervene without escalating danger, which is why the game is built around giving children a safe move for every situation rather than urging confrontation.
- **Naming harm enables action.** Children act when they can recognise gender-based harm in its many shapes (words, exclusion, touch, online) and know it's never the target's fault, so the game front-loads "name the harm" before "act".
- **Help-seeking must be taught and routed.** Reframing telling as help-seeking (not tattling) and giving a concrete helpline (Childline 1098 / 112) turns good intentions into a usable plan, the core of UNESCO 5.5.

Sources: Right To Be / Hollaback! (the 5 Ds of bystander intervention); Childline India Foundation (1098). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 21 games now v2. Next in Chapter 3: Defenders of the Body (g20, body safety & reporting).